

Rocket

The first rockets blasted Chinese fireworks into the sky a thousand years ago. Now they send people into space.

It is ROCKET SCIENCE, actually!

By the way... My V-2 rocket flew at more than 3,420 mph (5,500 km/h), and delivered a ton of explosives.

Wernher von Braun led the team behind the first US satellite and the Moon landings.

We have liftoff!

To **soar into the sky**, a rocket needs enough fuel to lift its weight, have a safe way of burning that fuel very quickly, and be able to work in an airless environment if it gets to space. American scientist **Robert Goddard** was the first to solve these problems: He launched the world's first liquid-fueled rocket in 1926. It was light, but packed enough punch to just about **get it off the ground**, though it didn't reach space.

Wernher's V-2

People realized that rockets could be used both to send humans into space and to fire **weapons**. German Wernher von Braun's **V-2 rocket** was first used in 1944 during World War II. After Germany was defeated in the war, von Braun moved to the United States and pursued his dream of developing rockets for **SPACE TRAVEL**.

It paved the way for...

The **V-2** was the first ballistic missile. The first intercontinental ballistic missile, the **SOVIET R-7**, was launched in 1957.



The **MARINER 2**, launched by a rocket, became the first space probe to visit another planet when it reached **VENUS** in 1962.

